University of New Hampshire
Peter T. Paul College of Business and Economics

ECON 402: PRINCIPLES OF MICROECONOMICS

FALL 2025

,Course Information:

Course ID:	ECON 402	**Credit Hours:**	4
Department:		Economics	
Start/End Dates:		8/25/2025 - 12/08/2025	
Class Times/Location:		Sec. 5&6: M&W 8:10 am - 9:30 am @ Paul Creative Arts Center M223 Sec. 9&10: M&W 11:10 am - 12:30 pm @ PCBE G85	
Attributes:		This course is a Social Science Discovery course	
Textbook:		Stevenson and Wolfers. 2023. *Principles of Microeconomics (2nd edition)* See the Textbook & Software section for details	
Software (required):		MacMillan Achieve eTextbook and iClicker access are provided within Achieve subscription for one school term.	

Instructor Information:

Instructor:	Bingjin (Ben) Xue Assistant Professor of Economics
Office Location/Phone:	Paul College 321 (603) 862- 3364
Office Hours:	M & W 10:00 am – 11:00 am or by appointment
Email Address **Preferred Method of Contact:**	bingjin.xue@unh.edu Discussion forum on MyCourses are preferred contact for course-related questions and I will respond within one business day.
Teaching Assistants:	Hailey Ranfos Hailey.Ranfos@unh.edu

Course Overview

In this course we examine how individuals, firms and societies make choices when faced with scarcity. We will focus on the role of markets, how prices are determined, and the influence that prices have on how individuals and societies allocate resources and time. We will identify cases where markets don't work well and explore the causes of market failure. Finally, we will examine firms and how they interact in different competitive environments. Collectively, our examination of economics will give us a way of understanding how to make the best use of natural resources, technology, and people's unique skills.

Prerequisites

This course utilizes math skills including basic algebra, graphing, and calculating percentages.

Learning Objectives

By course end it is expected that you will be able to:

- Have a good understanding of microeconomic principles and issues.
- Apply the marginal principle and the concept of opportunity cost.
- Make use of the model of demand and supply tools to explain market outcomes.
- Understand the concept and sources of market failure and analyze market outcomes in the presence of market failures.
- Explain firms' decisions over pricing, output, and entry in competitive and noncompetitive environments.
- Evaluate the gains and losses from government policies.

Textbook & Software:

- **Textbook**: Stevenson and Wolfers. 2023. Principles of Microeconomics (2nd edition)
  ISBN: 9781319603885
- **Macmillan Achieve**: All students must purchase access to Macmillan's Achieve learning suite and register for iClicker (free for Achieve users). The textbook eBook is included in the Achieve Access. You need Achieve to access homework and assignments.
- Important! To avoid account linking issues, it is recommended that you purchase Achieve access through the Macmillan Learning section on our course site on MyCourses (To ensure that MyCourses/Canvas is linked to Macmillan, please do NOT go to the Achieve website directly
- If you purchased Achieve access elsewhere, when creating an Achieve account, you MUST specify your email address in the following **format:** abc123@unh.edu (This is the mixture of the first part of your USNH email but with the @UNH.edu affix), otherwise, your grade will not be synced to Canvas. Do **not** use your @USNH.edu email (acb1234@usnh.edu) or your name email (john.doe@unh.edu).

Learning Management Systems:

MyCourses is the learning management tool we use for this course. The site will be used to post announcements, maintain a gradebook and provide a discussion forum. In addition, we will use Macmillan's Achieve learning suite for homework assignments. The two platforms are already integrated. You can find a link to the Achieve learning suite on MyCourses home page.

Grades & Grading Scale

The course grade consists of the following components:

Homework Assignments – on Achieve	20%
Three Midterm Exams – in person	10% x 3 (30% total)
One Final Exam – in person	20%
Bonus Entry *	15%
Participation **	15%
Total	**100%**

*The bonus entry is the highest midterm or final exam grade.
** Participation is assessed by random in-class quizzes using iClicker

The following scale, which is the standard UNH grading scale, determines letter grades. Grades do NOT get rounded up.

Percentage	Grade	Percentage	Grade
94–100	A	77–79.99	C+
90–93.99	A-	74-76.99	C
87–89.99	B+	70–73.99	C-
84-86.99	B	69.99 or lower	D or F
80–83.99	B-		

Assignment Details

- **Achieve Assignments:** Every week there are at least one problem set on Achieve.

- **Midterm Exams** will be in person at **7:10 p.m.** on

  - Thursday, September 25
  - Thursday, October 23
  - Thursday, November 20

  You must be available to take the exams on those dates and times, so please adjust extracurricular and work schedules accordingly. Exams may include material discussed in lectures but not covered in the text, or vice versa.

- **Final Exam** is cumulative, but prior to the final, I will announce select chapters that will be covered on the test. Chapters with material that is less essential will be excluded. The exam is in person and required for the course. The exam date and time are determined by the University's master schedule and will be announced as we approach the second half of the semester.

- **Exam Policies:**
  - Missed Exams**:** In case of documentable emergency, students must contact the instructor prior to the exam/assignment date.

  - Exam Rules**:** Exams must be taken at the stated exam time. You may not use notes or the book during the exam. Phones must be zipped inside a purse or backpack and may not be accessed during the exam (even if it rings). You may use a non-programable calculator. The exam will be administered at a specified time must be completed in one sitting.

- **Bonus Entry:** Because anyone can have a bad day, the gradebook includes a bonus entry that is intended to put more weight on the best exam grade. This entry is equal to the best exam grade (midterms or final).

- **Participation:** You will frequently be asked to respond to progress assessments during lecture days. These assessments account for 15% of your total grade and cannot be made up. The participation final grade is averaged over all assessments given in the semester.

- **Missed Class:** If you must miss class for any reason, it is your responsibility to ensure you keep up with material and turn in assignments on time. I strongly recommend that you review the relevant material on the MyCourses site and (re)read the chapter from the textbook; if possible, have another student provide you with a scan or copy of their notes from the session you missed. Please contact your instructor or a TA with any questions about the material or assignments you missed.

Policy on Late Submissions

Achieve Homework Assignments may be submitted up to 7 days late, but for each day past the deadline that you take, you will incur a 10% penalty.[1]

Course Workload and Credit Hours

This syllabus reflects the federal definition of a credit hour, which entails a minimum 3 hours of engaged time per week per credit over a 15-week semester (student workload for

[1] For example, if you would have earned an 88% but you submitted 2 days late, the grade would be a 68%.

shorter length terms must be increased proportionally per week to maintain required approximately 45 hours of work per credit per term). Examples of engaged time include class time, assignments, examinations, laboratories, participation in course-related experiences (attending a talk or performance, speakers and events, fieldwork, etc.), conferences, and office hours. Student work reflects intended learning outcomes and is verified through evidence of student achievement.

Course Schedule

The course is organized according to 4 modules that each cover approximately 3-4 weeks of course material. Each module is further divided into topics, each of which normally corresponds to roughly one chapter of material from the course.

Module	Topic Covered	Textbook Readings
August 25	**First Day of Semester**	
Module 1	Intro to microeconomics & Key Principles	• Chapter 1
	Demand	• Chapter 2
	Supply	• Chapter 3
	Equilibrium in Supply and Demand	• Chapter 4
Sept 25 (Th)	**Midterm I - 7:10pm @ Spaulding Life Science (SLS) 145**	
Module 2	Elasticity and Revenues	• Chapter 5
	Government Intervention in Markets	• Chapter 6
	Welfare and Efficiency	• Chapter 7
Oct 23 (Th)	**Midterm II - 7:10pm @ SLS 145**	
Module 3	Public Goods & Externalities	• Chapter 10
	Private Information	• Chapter 19
Nov 20 (Th)	**Midterm III - 7:10pm @ SLS 145**	
Module 4	Market Structure and Market Power	• Chapter 14
	Entry, Exit, and Long-Run Profitability	• Chapter 15
	Price Discrimination	• Chapter 16
	Game Theory	• Chapter 18
Final Exam	**Refer to the Final Exam Matrix for Date and Time; More Details Can be found on Canvas.**	

Student to Instructor Communication Expectations

How to Reach Me

Discussion Forum:

A Discussions tab can be found on MyCourses. Questions related to assignments or learning should first be asked here, if possible, so that the answers are visible to all other students. I will be active in the MyCourses class area daily, Monday through Friday. If you post a question for me in the discussion forum, anticipate a response within 24 hours or sooner.

Email:

Bingjin.Xue@unh.edu

The use of email is reserved for questions of a private nature. If you would like to send me an email, please anticipate a response within 48 hours.

In-person Office hours:

Monday and Wednesday 10:00 a.m. – 11:00 a.m.
or by appointment

Technical Requirements and Technical Support

Technical assistance related to Canvas is available at
https://td.unh.edu/TDClient/60/Portal/KB/ArticleDet?ID=1278

Mental Health and Wellness

Your academic success and overall mental health are very important. If, during the semester, you find you are experiencing emotional or mental health issues, please contact the University's (PACS) (3rd floor, Smith Hall; 603-862-2090/TTY: 7-1-1; https://www.unh.edu/pacs/) which provides counseling appointments and other mental health services. If urgent, students may call PACS M-F, 8 a.m.-5 p.m., and schedule an Urgent Same-Day Appointment.

University Disability Accommodations

According to the Americans with Disabilities Act (as amended, 2008), each student with a disability has the right to request services from UNH to accommodate his/her/their disability. If you are a student with a documented disability or believe you may have a disability that requires an accommodation, please contact Student Accessibility Services (SAS) at 201 Smith Hall. Accommodation letters are created by SAS with the student. Please follow up with your instructor as soon as possible to ensure timely implementation of the identified accommodations in the letter. Faculty have an obligation to respond once they receive official notice of accommodations but are under no obligation to provide retroactive accommodations.
For more information refer to https://www.unh.edu/studentaccessibility or contact SAS at 603.862.2607, 711 (Relay NH) or sas.office@unh.edu.

Academic Honesty and Plagiarism

Students are required to abide by the UNH Academic Honesty policy located in the Student Rights, Rules, and Responsibilities Handbook. Incidents of academic dishonesty may be grounds for receiving an "F" in an assignment or an "F" in the overall course. Incidents are reported to the school dean and may be grounds for further action. If you are in doubt, please contact me for clarification on the rules governing any particular assignment. Additional resources can be found here

Note: **This syllabus is subject to change. Students will be promptly notified of any changes.**